

# Thoughts on Furies?

## LGBTQ+ phobia can hide in some strange places...

Mary Rose Krouse • DATA-510: MSDS Capstone • Summer 2026



### Abstract

The “furry” fan community is one centered around an interest in animal characters in art, from film to costume. These fans, individually called “furries,” are not only majority LGBTQ+, but also highly stigmatized, as a common punching bag for cyberbullying, misinformation, and even some political scapegoating [1]. Through a survey on people’s thoughts on both furries and issues involving the LGBTQ+ community, this project seeks to investigate the suggestion that attitudes toward furries and toward diverse sexual orientations and gender identities may be related.

### Research Question

**Are unfavorable attitudes toward furries significantly associated with stigma toward LGBTQ+ people and issues? How does the relationship with furry favorability differ between attitudes toward gender identity (including transgender/non-binary/2-spirit/etc. people and issues) versus toward sexual orientation (including gay/homosexual/bisexual/pansexual/etc. people and issues)?**

### Motivation

In the current climate of rising political and cultural threats to the rights and livelihood of LGBTQ+ people within the United States and beyond [2], being an effective ally is increasingly important. Strong allyship ends with concrete and ongoing action in support of pro-LGBTQ+ causes, but it also begins with a look inward at personal biases. This extends all the way down to examining small, unconscious, or seemingly innocuous gut feelings. For example, *why might some niche subculture with strong ties to the LGBTQ+ community make you feel a certain way?* **This project is intended for allies to the LGBTQ+ community, providing furry as a case study of where stigma and feelings of discomfort are common, yet also associated with homophobia and transphobia.**

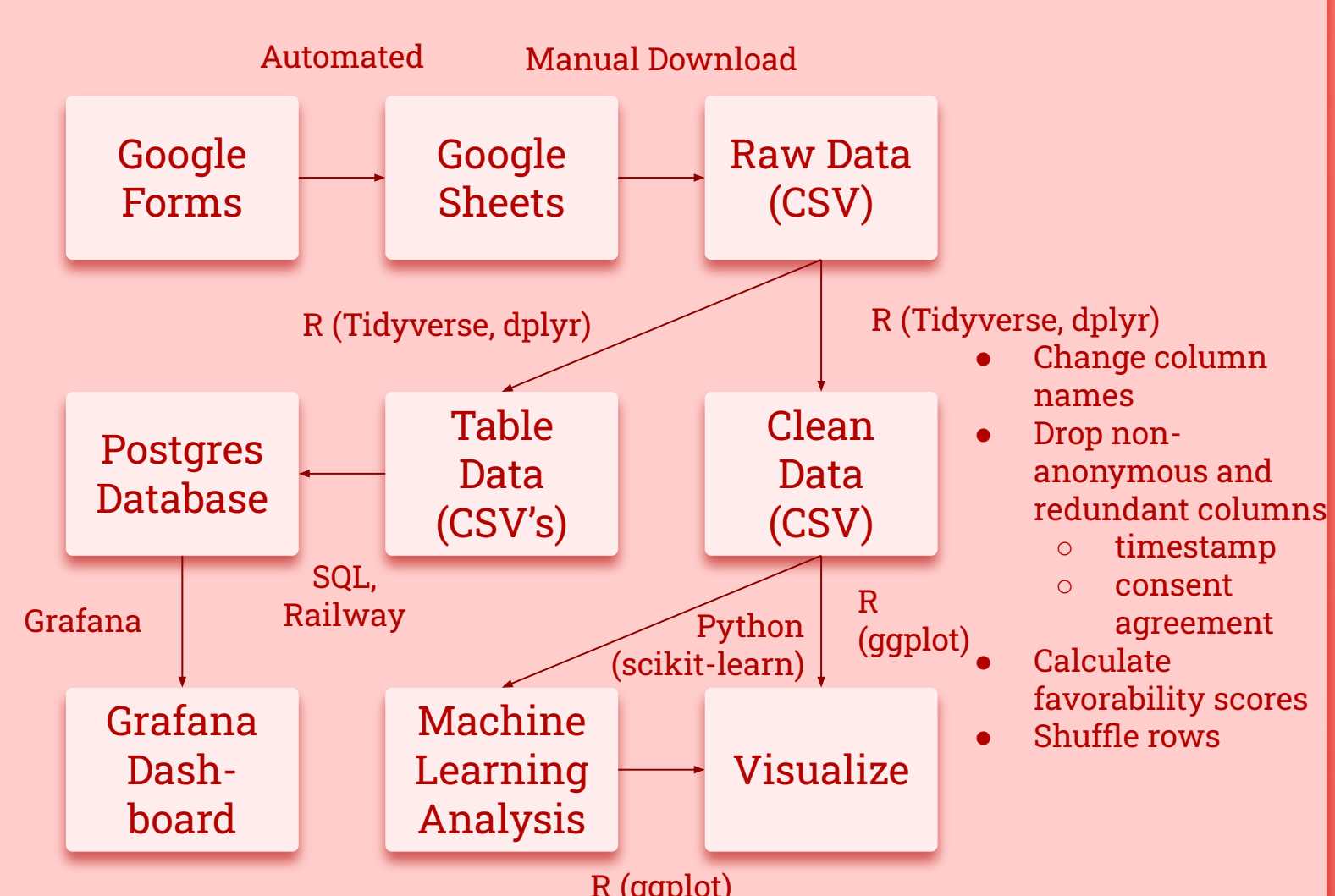
### Related Work

Existing research into the furry fandom has largely been conducted by the International Anthropomorphic Research Project (**IARP**) and presented through its public face, **Furscience.com**. IARP presents the furry fandom as a case study of a stigmatized community, with the goal of de-stigmatizing [1]. Most of its research involves conducting surveys within the furry fandom and other fan communities. Though my goal is similar, my personal data collection differs in that I instead attempt to survey a sample of outside attitudes beyond the furry community, as broadly as possible. Additionally, my motivations extend beyond the interests of furries themselves, to the broader LGBTQ+ community.

### Ethics & Limitations

Lorem ipsum

### Data Engineering

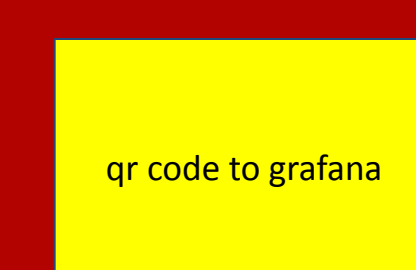


### Data Sources

- Primary Data**  
*on attitudes toward furries, etc.*
- Survey conducted by author
  - Online & in-person, 2026
  - 208 respondents
- Outside Data**  
*on furry gender & sexual identities*
- Survey conducted by the International Anthropomorphic Research Project
    - Unpublished dataset; acquired with permission of Dr. Courtney Plante
  - Online & in-person, 2023
  - 995 respondents

**Repository:** <https://github.com/MaryR0se/Mary-Krouse-Capstone-Repo> **References:**

- Roberts, S. E., Davies-Kneis, C., Gerbasi, K., Fein, E., Plante, C., Reysen, S., & Côté, J. (2023). Seeding the Grassroots of Research on Furies: Lessons Learned from 15 Years of Creative Knowledge Mobilization, Valuing Community Partnerships, and Correcting the Record on Stigmatized Communities with Evidence-Based Scholarship. *Deviant Behavior*, 45(1), 50–79. <https://doi.org/10.1080/01639625.2023.2237634>
- Mapping Attacks on LGBTQ Rights in U.S. State Legislatures in 2026. (2026, July 9). American Civil Liberties Union. Retrieved July 13, 2026, from <https://www.aclu.org/legislative-attacks-on-lgbtq-rights-2026>



See the response data!



Try the survey!

